Stop Prompting. *Start Training.*

A Skill is a set of saved instructions your AI opens when the task matches. You write down how **you** do a repeatable job once. After that, you stop re-explaining it every time. The pattern works in more than one tool: a Claude Skill or Project, a custom GPT, a Gemini Gem, or a Copilot agent. Names and plans vary, so check what your company allows.

STEP 1

Fill in your Skill spec

The task I do every week is _____ .
It takes me about _____ minutes each time.
The AI should use this when I say _____ .
The AI's role is a partner who _____ , not one who _____ .
The output should sound like _____ (3 words, your voice).
Three rules it must never break: _____ / _____ / _____

STEP 2

Is it worth writing?

- [ ] **Repeatable.** You do it at least weekly.
- [ ] **Easy to trigger.** You can say when to use it in one sentence.
- [ ] **Carries your judgment.** Voice, format, rules a smart stranger would not know.
- [ ] **Checkable.** You can tell in 10 seconds if it did the job.

Missed one? Keep prompting for now. A task that changes every time is not ready to be saved.

BEFORE YOU PASTE ANYTHING

Keep it safe

Ask IT which AI tool is approved for work.

Build your first Skill on a task with no confidential data, or swap in made-up names and numbers.

Your rules are the valuable part. Write them in your own words.

AI can still get facts wrong. Check what matters before it leaves your desk.

THE LINE THAT DECIDES EVERYTHING

Write the description like you are labeling a folder

GETS IGNORED

"Helps with emails."

The AI cannot tell when to reach for it.

GETS USED

"Weekly status update writer. Turns my rough notes into a 5-bullet update for my director. Use when I paste notes and say 'status update'."

KEEP GOING · FREE

Get this card + a new Skill to steal, *in your inbox.*

Scan, or go to **alisonicolee.com/skill**

YOUR FIRST WEEK

The Monday *15.*

1	**Pick the task.** Choose something you did last week and will do again this week. Small beats impressive.	2 MIN
2	**Write the trigger.** One sentence: "Use this when I ask you to _____." If you cannot finish it, pick a different task.	3 MIN
3	**Dump your rules.** Voice in 3 words, 3 never-do rules, and one example of a good result. Plain text is fine.	5 MIN
4	**Test on real work.** Run it on something from yesterday. Remove names and numbers first if the content is confidential.	3 MIN
5	**Fix the weakest part.** Did it not fire? Sharpen the trigger line first. Did it miss your voice? Add an example, not more rules.	2 MIN

Done means: saved, and used on real work twice by Friday. **Friday:** show one coworker what it does.

PASTE-READY

```
Name: weekly-status-update
Description: [what it does + exactly when to use it, one sentence]
Role: You are my writing partner for [task]. I am the author.
Voice: [3 words], like I would say it to [who]
Format: [length, structure, where the point goes]
Never: 1. [rule]   2. [rule]   3. [rule]
A good one looks like: [paste a real past example, details removed]
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THREE TO STEAL

Weekly status update

TRIGGER
"Status update" + my rough notes.

RULES
Lead with the outcome. Five bullets max. Flag any risk in the first line.

Meeting follow-up

TRIGGER
"Follow-up" + my meeting notes.

RULES
Owner and date on every action. Under 150 words. Never invent a commitment.

Hard-email tone check

TRIGGER
"Tone check" + my draft.

RULES
Point out what reads cold. Do not rewrite my draft. Keep my words where you can.

WHERE IT LIVES

IF YOU USE	SAVE IT AS
Claude	A Skill, or the instructions of a Project
ChatGPT	A custom GPT, or custom instructions
Gemini	A Gem
Microsoft Copilot	An agent or saved prompt your admin allows

STAY IN THE LOOP

Follow me on LinkedIn for *new Skills every week.*

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